



Here are some popular characters being cosplayed by our very talented cosplayers. We have Aorin as Lina, Pracheta as Inu Yasha and Rhea as Killer Frost and Froslass.



do if we ever got those because who knows, there could be a radioactive accident just around the corner and we should be mentally prepared for the aftereffects right? Cosplaying in a way, is literally living the dream for some of these guys. At the core of it all, they do it because they enjoy doing it and have fun when they do it.

For others it's a hobby that lets them explore their creativity. Syrinx and Aorin enjoy the process and work that goes into cosplay as much as the actual cosplaying itself. Cosplaying isn't just simply donning a costume and playing make believe. These guys enjoy the effort that goes into making their outfits and pushing the bounds of their creativity. According to Aorin, "The whole process of creating something and then being someone else is amazing and truly magical".

Pracheta Banerjee feels that a lot of people don't even try. They feel like they can't look like a certain character and

give up even before trying. She takes this as a challenge and her main reason for cosplaying is, "to simply bring out the fact that our looks aren't limited".

As for what inspired them to start, for the guys at Scythes SkunkWorks it came in the form of "a Facebook invite from an old acquaintance, and a newspaper article (divine intervention?) in 2013", which was when they first heard about the Mumbai Film and Comic Convention (MFCC). For others it was something that fascinated them, something that they could enjoy doing with friends, and something that would help them meet new people. And the rest are inspired by their love for the characters that they choose to cosplay. Just enjoying what it is they do and finding inspiration within that.

Cosplaying is a relatively young hobby, with most starting out within the last 5 years. Most of the cosplayers we reached out to had first started cosplaying back in 2011. Back then it didn't have

as much attention as it does now, and now with more and more people being more open to trying new things and welcoming different cultures, surely the number of cosplayers will be on the rise.

While cosplaying itself is a young hobby, the guys who've been doing it since then have been doing it for a long time. What inspires them to continue to pursue this hobby? Pracheta was initially inspired by fashion magazines, and the cosplay featured in them, which keeps her going. The guys at Scythes SkunkWorks say that the hours of time, blood and sweat they put in to prepare and create their costumes and props in order to bring their character to life and do "justice to their heroes", is what keeps them going. Furthermore, they said, "the community, the support and encouragement we get, all of it keep us inspired and motivated to go on." In fact, for most of the cosplayers we asked it's their friends, the community, and their fellow cosplayers who encourage them and inspire them to continue doing what they do. After all, we geeks are a close knit community and we support each other whole-heartedly.

THE FUN

Everyone derives their own kind of fun from cosplaying, it could be something specific, such as wigs, as is the case with Aorin (she's made it very evident that she loves wigs so we had to mention it). Or it could just be the entire process